



Delaware County Commissioners Meeting September 7th 2021

Meeting Metadata	Details
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Delaware County Commissioners Meeting Report

Meeting Date: September 7, 2021

Prepared by: Expert Civic Analyst

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order:** Presiding Officer Sherry (Commissioner) called the Delaware County Commissioners meeting to order at **00:00:09** on Tuesday, September 7, 2021, at 9:02 AM, opening with the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Mr. Henry, Ms. Reagan (via Zoom), Mr. King, Mr. Brook (Presiding Officer Sherry / Mr. Henry / Mr. King / Mr. Brook noted as commissioners).
 - **Absent:** None noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Sherry.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance **00:00:16**.

- **Approval of Minutes:** 00:01:13 The board approved the August 12, 2021 special meeting minutes and the August 16, 2021 regular commissioners meeting minutes.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call Vote (Reagan: yes, Henry: yes, King: yes).
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3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:00:52 Tabled Business: Ordinance to Limit Weight and Commercial Truck Traffic on County Roads in Delaware County**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Staff / Commissioners.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Commissioners requested to keep the ordinance on the table because the draft was not yet finished following a recent meeting with Tommy and Angie.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Continued on the Table (No formal vote taken; left tabled by consensus).
- **00:01:39 Presentation / Request: Heart of Indiana United Way Campaign Approval**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jenny Marsh (President & CEO) and Holly Yipe.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Jenny Marsh presented an update on the newly merged United Way of Delaware County (now Heart of Indiana United Way, serving five counties: Delaware, Fayette, Henry, Madison, and Randolph) to streamline back-office operations. She noted that nearly 47% of households cannot make ends meet (ALICE or in poverty). During the COVID-19 pandemic, they granted \$1.027 million in Delaware County for food, energy, and education, in addition to their standing \$830,000 commitment to 26 local nonprofits. They requested the board's approval to run a workplace giving campaign among county employees coordinated by Holly Yipe.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by consensus/board support directing them to coordinate with HR Director Mrs. McCammon.
- **00:03:34 Contract / RFP: Pharmacy Benefit Manager (PBM) Review**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Bill Sylvester, Apex Benefits.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented a proposal to issue an RFP for a new Pharmacy Benefit Manager (PBM) to address specialty medication costs, estimating savings of over \$200,000 for the county.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Henry: yes, Reagan: yes, King: yes).
- **00:07:32 Contract: Online Benefit Administration System (Steel Benefits)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Bill Sylvester, Apex Benefits.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposed implementing an online benefit administration system via Steel Benefits (or alternative carriers using tech credits) to streamline HR and payroll enrollment in a cost-neutral manner, replacing paper enrollment.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Reagan: yes, Henry: yes, King: yes).
- **00:07:32 Presentation: Delaware-Muncie Comprehensive Plan ("Together DM") Update**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Marta Moody (Executive Director, Delaware-Muncie Plan Commission), Pete Lombardi (Project Manager), Thomas Eddington, and Matt Ingles.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Consultants provided an update on the 20-year update to the Muncie-Delaware County Comprehensive Plan and the accompanying Strategic Investment Plans. The project focuses on three core priorities identified via surveys, open houses, and focus groups: (1) Improving quality of place (focusing heavily on deteriorating road conditions, where 63% need reconstruction/rehabilitation); (2) Strengthening housing conditions and options (evaluating 33,000+ properties); and (3) Cultivating opportunities for upward mobility. Commissioners and staff discussed local concerns regarding rural broadband access and public transit/bus staffing shortages. The second online survey runs through September 17, with open houses planned for early October and final adoption targeted for December.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Received and filed (Informational presentation; no board action required).
- **00:29:58 Contract Renewal: Peterson Consulting Asset Reporting**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Craycraft.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Annual renewal of the asset inventory and reporting contract with Peterson Consulting, which has managed county assets for the past 5<U+2013>6 years.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Reagan: yes, Henry: yes, King: yes).
- **00:30:30 Contract: US Signal Off-Network Cloud Data Backup Solution**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jim Fluke, IT Department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented an off-network, month-to-month cloud backup solution with US Signal to safeguard county data against ransomware and cyber-attacks. The trial period will run 6 to 8 months. Billed strictly on actual data utilized (max estimated at \$500/month). Funding is available in the current IT budget for the trial period.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Henry: yes, Reagan: yes, King: yes).
- **00:35:29 Grant Certification Letter: Statewide 911 Equipment Cleanup**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Ritter, 911 Center.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for signatures and the county<U+2019>s DUNS number on a federal grant certification letter required by NISA and NTIA as part of a review cleanup for a 2021 federal grant that replaced 911 call-handling equipment.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Reagan: yes, Henry: yes, King: yes).
- **00:36:47 Discussion / Introduction: Commissioners' American Rescue Plan (ARP) Spending Plan**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** John / Commissioners.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented Version 11.6 of the county's ARP spending plan (\$11 million received this year, \$11 million expected next year) for review prior to formal adoption and council appropriation. The plan heavily prioritizes infrastructure (including water/sewer projects in Albany and Eden leveraging SWIFGR grants, and the Daleville sewer lift station via the regional wastewater district), a mental health and rehabilitation treatment center build-out at the new justice center, and \$250,000 for fairgrounds building/sprinkler repairs. Total planned projects exceed \$27 million, accounting for potential external grant offsets.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved for Introduction by Roll Call Vote (Reagan: yes, Henry: yes, King: yes; to be finalized at the next meeting).
- **00:46:15 Contract: Maintenance Services Agreement for Superintendent Steve Foster**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners / County Attorney.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** A contractual services agreement to compensate incoming Maintenance Superintendent Steve Foster prior to November 1, when the full-time salaried line becomes funded due to outgoing superintendent Charlie Walker's accrued vacation/overtime scheduling.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Henry: yes, Reagan: yes, King: yes).
- **00:47:16 Department Head Report: Security Ordinances & Cell Phone Policy (Ordinance 2021-009 & 2021-021)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily Anderson / Commissioners.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed discrepancies between Ordinance 2021-009 (which permitted employees to carry weapons in buildings with supervisory permission) and Ordinance 2021-021 (which omitted that language and introduced corridor cell phone rules that contradict judicial court orders on electronic devices). Commissioners confirmed they are working to clean up and revise the ordinances.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational / Under revision by Mr. Brook and commissioners.
- **00:49:19 Traffic Safety Discussion: Speeding and Traffic Control at Delaware Lake Reservoir**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioner / Linda Michael (Citizen).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Commissioners and a local business owner (Linda Michael, co-owner of Michael's Drydock Marina) raised severe safety concerns regarding excessive speeding (speeds clocked at 40-65+ mph in a 30 mph zone), traffic congestion, and accidents near the reservoir, park, and marina. The county

recently purchased four electronic speed signs and plans to install stop signs at key intersections (beach area / 400 South / 450).

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Consensus to draft a formal traffic ordinance for stop sign installations to be voted on at the next meeting.
- **00:48:00 Payment of Claims**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Review of regular county claims totaling \$4,263,020.30.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Henry: yes, Reagan: yes).

4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:51:01 Linda Michael** (Resident and Marina Co-Owner) spoke during the department head/traffic forum regarding persistent, dangerous speeding (70+ mph recorded by sheriff's deputies) along the reservoir roadway near the park and marina, thanking the commissioners for taking action to install stop signs and parking restrictions. *(Note: No separate public comment speakers signed up during the formal public comment period at 00:54:56).*

5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Announcements:** ARP plan and traffic stop-sign ordinances scheduled for formal action/approval at the next meeting.
- **Adjournment:** **00:55:23** The meeting was officially adjourned following a motion to recess/adjourn, passed by roll call vote (Reagan: yes, Henry: yes, King: yes).

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